

HIDDEN TOOLS DECISION MAP

When you face a problem, pick the right tool:

- "Is this file safe?" → Windows Sandbox
 - "I need a full VM I'll reuse" → Hyper-V
 - "Things started breaking recently" → Reliability Monitor
 - "I need error details / what exactly failed" → Event Viewer
 - "I want Windows to do this automatically" → Task Scheduler / schtasks
- That's it. No overthinking.

- Event ID
- The description

Fast Track interpretation rule: One-off errors happen even on healthy systems. You care about patterns:

- repeated errors
- errors that match your symptoms
- errors that started recently (use Reliability Monitor to correlate)

Step-by-step: Track boot issues or driver weirdness

1. Open Event Viewer.
2. Go to Windows Logs → System.
3. Filter by Error/Critical.
4. Look for sources related to:
 - drivers
 - disk
 - networking
 - services failing to start

And yes, this is exactly what IT support asks for when they want "logs." Now you know where that comes from.

5) Task Scheduler: automation without "apps that run in the background forever"

Task Scheduler is Windows' built-in automation engine. It runs tasks based on triggers (time-based or event-based) and executes actions (run a program, run a script, etc.). Microsoft's Task Scheduler documentation describes this trigger/action model clearly.

This is the feature that turns "I keep forgetting" into "Windows does it for me."

What Task Scheduler is good for

- Launching apps at specific times (daily standup? open Notes/Teams)
- Running cleanup scripts weekly
- Backups at night

- Auto-reminders (open a file, run a script)
- Running tasks at logon/startup (without bloating startup apps)

Step-by-step: Open Task Scheduler

1. Start → type Task Scheduler → open

Step-by-step: Create a Basic Task (the beginner-friendly way)

1. In the right panel, click Create Basic Task...
2. Give it a name (e.g., "Open Study Folder")
3. Choose a Trigger (Daily / Weekly / When I log on)
4. Choose an Action: Start a program
5. Browse to:
 - an app executable, or
 - a file/folder shortcut

6. Finish and test

(If you want the deeper command-line method, Windows also includes schtasks, which Microsoft documents as a tool to create and manage scheduled tasks.)

Two ready-to-copy tasks for Indian users

Task A: Open your "Work" folder every weekday at 9:30 AM

- Trigger: Weekly → Mon–Fri → 9:30 AM
- Action: Start a program → point it to File Explorer with your folder path (or a shortcut)

This is basic, but it builds a habit: the work folder opens when work starts.

Task B: Weekly "maintenance reminder" (non-destructive)

Instead of running "cleaners," schedule a reminder that opens Windows Storage settings.

- Trigger: Weekly → Sunday evening
- Action: Start a program → open Settings (or a shortcut to Storage)

The point is to build a ritual without installing junk utilities.

Step-by-step: Create tasks using schtasks (for power users)

Microsoft documents [schtasks /create](#) for creating scheduled tasks with options like schedule type and triggers.

Example idea: run a script at logon (conceptually):

- `/sc onlogon` runs at logon
- `/tn` sets task name
- `/tr` sets what runs

Fast Track warning: command-line scheduling is powerful and easy to mess up. If you're new, stick to the GUI first. 